English

November 2026

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PART I · THE SYSTEM / MODULE 1

Start Here

This is not a traditional English course. It treats fluency as a **retrieval-speed problem**: you already know many words and rules, but conversation fails when useful sentence patterns do not appear fast enough. So the system stores *speakable units* — frames, chunks, and ready phrases — and drills them until they come out instantly.

It also targets a **minimally-marked General American accent** — the point where listeners stop noticing the accent — using ADHD-friendly micro-drills, not long shadowing sessions.

Design Principles

- **Smallest effective curriculum:** a tight, finishable core you can cycle several times, not a giant deck you abandon halfway.
- **Chunks over words:** store multi-word pieces you retrieve whole, not isolated vocabulary.
- **One concept per card:** every card is designed to take under 60 seconds.
- **Retrieval before knowledge:** speak first, then correct.
- **Spaced repetition:** re-meet cards on a schedule until they're automatic.
- **Visible progress:** daily scores, weekly recordings, and stage outcomes.
- **ADHD-friendly:** short loops, no long lectures, no giant lists in one session.
- **Minimally-marked accent:** General American as the model; rhythm first, then the few sounds that most flag an accent.
- **Audio-light, ADHD-first accent work:** 20–40 second micro-games and imitation of content you already enjoy — never long shadowing.

The 10-Minute Daily Loop

1. **1 min — Warm start:** retrieve yesterday's Box 1 cards aloud.
2. **3 min — Framework retrieval:** use 3 frameworks in new sentences.
3. **2 min — Chunk + correction:** use 2 chunks; fix one recurring mistake aloud.
4. **2 min — Prompt activation:** answer one prompt from the prompt bank.
5. **1 min — Accent micro-game or island:** one mode from the accent menu, or retell one island.
6. **1 min — Score:** mark retrieval speed, hesitation, and confidence.

Success Definition

By completing the core system, the learner should be able to:

- start and maintain everyday conversations,
- explain opinions and decisions,
- participate in professional discussions,
- reduce Malayalam-transfer grammar mistakes,
- speak with fewer and shorter pauses,
- sound minimally-marked in General American — clear, smooth, and hard to place.

What This System Removes

- long grammar chapters,
- rare vocabulary,
- passive listening marathons,
- long shadowing sessions and assigned audio,
- memorizing isolated word lists,
- exercises that do not transfer to speaking.

How To Use

Start with Daily 10-Minute Protocol (p. 5), follow the 8-week roadmap first, and use Metrics (p. 11) every week. Run the spaced-repetition ladder in Review Protocol (p. 9) so cards actually become automatic. Do not study more cards because motivation is high — the system works through **consistent short retrieval**, not heroic long sessions.

PART I · THE SYSTEM / MODULE 2

Daily 10-Minute Protocol

Use a timer. Stop at 10 minutes even if you feel motivated. Consistency beats intensity.

Minute-by-Minute

Minute	Action	Output
1	Warm start	Retrieve yesterday's Box 1 cards aloud (see review protocol).
2–4	Framework retrieval	Use 3 framework cards in new, real sentences.
5–6	Chunk + correction	Use 2 chunks aloud; fix 1 correction pattern.
7–8	Prompt activation	Answer 1 prompt from the prompt bank using today's cards.
9	Accent OR island	Run one mode from the accent menu, or retell one conversation island.
10	Score	Mark retrieval, hesitation, confidence (and on review days, longest fluent run).

Rotate minute 9: pick one accent menu mode (see Micro-Imitation Protocol, p. 57) most days; retell an island ~twice a week. Pick by mood — never force long audio.

Daily Rules

- If you cannot start a sentence within 3 seconds, the card drops to Box 1 and you repeat it tomorrow. Do **not** add more cards.
- Keep Box 1 small (~5–8 cards). Don't add new cards while it's full.
- Speak everything aloud. Silent reading does not build retrieval.

ADHD Friction Reducers

- Open today's cards and the prompt bank *before* starting the timer.
- Use a visible countdown timer.
- Speak standing up or walking if attention drops.
- Record only on review days, not every day.
- Always end with one visible score, even a rough one.

PART I · THE SYSTEM / MODULE 3

Roadmap

All roadmaps assume **10 minutes per day**. If you miss a day, do not compensate with a long session. Resume the next day. New cards flow through the spaced-repetition ladder in Review Protocol (p. 9).

Core Weekly Structure

- Days 1–5: learn and retrieve new cards (within the weekly budget).
- Day 6: mixed speaking practice + retell one conversation island.
- Day 7: record 60 seconds and score (including longest fluent run).
- Every day, minute 9: one accent menu mode — start with prosody (rhythm) from week 1, since it carries the most accent weight.

8-Week Sprint — Minimum Effective Fluency

Week	Focus	Daily Load	Expected Outcome
1	Core starters + confidence	3 frameworks, 2 chunks, 1 correction	Can begin answers without freezing.
2	Opinions + reasons	3 frameworks, 2 chunks, 1 correction	Can explain simple opinions with because/so/however.
3	Work & planning language	3 frameworks, 2 chunks, 2 expressions	Can discuss tasks, timelines, priorities.
4	Clarifying, asking & bridges	2 frameworks, 4 expressions, 1 correction	Can ask for context, repeat, confirm, and recover without freezing.
5	Story & experience + islands	3 frameworks, 2 chunks, build 2 islands	Can describe past events with fewer tense errors.
6	Agreement / disagreement	2 frameworks, 4 expressions, 1 correction	Can participate in discussions politely.
7	Accent: rhythm & key sounds	2 frameworks, prosody cards + 2 segmental tells	Stronger GenAm rhythm; the top sounds less marked.
8	Integration	mixed review + island retells	Can speak for 2 minutes on common topics with a measurably longer fluent run.

12-Week Build — Professional Conversation Readiness

Phase	Weeks	Focus	Expected Outcome
Foundation	1–4	starters, chunks, corrections	Short answers become faster and cleaner.
Expansion	5–8	planning, meetings, decisions, islands	Can handle work updates and problem-solving talk.
Control	9–12	nuance, repair, bridges, pronunciation	Can clarify, disagree, summarize, and recover smoothly.

24-Week Maintenance — 90–95% Practical Fluency Target

Phase	Weeks	Goal	Expected Outcome
Activation	1–4	make known English speakable	Faster sentence starts.
Stabilization	5–8	reduce common errors	More accurate everyday speech.
Professional Range	9–12	meetings, planning, decisions	Stronger workplace participation.
Spontaneity	13–16	random prompts and stories	Less freezing under pressure.
Clarity	17–20	pronunciation and stress	Easier listening comprehension for others.
Autonomy	21–24	self-directed speaking loops	Learner can maintain fluency without course dependency.

The core deck is small (~300 cards), but at the weekly card budget a full pass takes about 18 weeks — the 90 corrections are the longest deck. On the 8- and 12-week paths, prioritize the cards you need most (the corrections you actually make, per the review loop) and spend spare time *repeating* high-value cards — which is where fluency is actually built.

Pareto Rule For Skipping

Skip an item only if you can already use it instantly in speech three times in a row with no hesitation. Recognition is not enough.

PART I · THE SYSTEM / MODULE 4

Weekly Sprints

Weekly Card Budget

Keep it small so cards actually graduate through the spaced-repetition ladder:

- 10 frameworks,
- 8 chunks,
- 8 expressions,
- 5 corrections,
- 1–2 accent targets (prosody first, then a segmental tell),
- keep 1 conversation island warm.

Do not add new cards while Box 1 (daily review) is full.

Weekly Review Day

Record a 60-second answer to one prompt (see Prompt Bank, p. 46), for example:

1. What did you work on this week?
2. What problem did you solve recently?
3. What is one decision you need to make?
4. What is one thing you are learning?

Score using Metrics (p. 11). Note your **longest fluent run** so it can grow week to week.

Progress Rule

A week is successful if speaking feels about 5% easier, not if every card is perfect.

PART I · THE SYSTEM / MODULE 5

Review Protocol

Fluency comes from *re-meeting* cards until retrieval is instant — not from seeing each card once. This protocol gives you a concrete spaced-repetition rhythm, a weekly recording loop, and an optional AI feedback loop.

Spaced Repetition (Leitner Ladder)

Keep cards in five boxes. A card moves up a box each time you can start a correct sentence with it within 3 seconds. If you hesitate or get it wrong, it drops back to Box 1.

Box	Review every	Meaning
1	every day	new or recently failed
2	every 3 days	starting to stick
3	every 7 days	mostly automatic
4	every 14 days	nearly owned
5	"warm" — once a month	owned; just keep it alive

Rules:

- A card **graduates** to Box 5 only after 4 instant, correct retrievals in a row (one box per success).
- Only ~5–8 cards should be in Box 1 at a time. Don't add new cards while Box 1 is full.
- Recognition does not count. If you can only *recognize* it, it stays in Box 1.

A simple paper version: five columns; move a tally mark right on success, back to column 1 on a miss.

Daily Micro-Review

Before any new cards, retrieve yesterday's Box 1 cards aloud. This is the first minute of the daily protocol.

Weekly Review

1. Record a 60-second answer to one prompt from Prompt Bank (p. 46).
2. Count silent pauses longer than 2 seconds.
3. Note your **longest fluent run** (seconds without a >2s pause).
4. Note up to 3 repeated errors — then pick **only one** to target next week.
5. Save one sentence you said well; reuse it.

Monthly Review

Re-record the same prompt you used four weeks ago and compare:

- Did sentence starts get faster?
- Did pauses drop / did the longest fluent run get longer?
- Did the same grammar errors repeat less?
- Is pronunciation clearer on your target sounds?
- Can you speak longer without panic?

Optional: AI Feedback Loop

This turns the static curriculum into a feedback engine using the corrections deck.

1. Record your 60-second answer and get a transcript (any speech-to-text, or type out what you said).
2. Paste the transcript to an AI assistant with this prompt:

   > "I'm a Malayalam-speaking English learner. Here is a transcript of me speaking. Using common Indian/ Malayalam-English transfer errors, point out: (1) any error patterns you see, (2) my top 3 errors to fix first, and (3) a more natural version of 2–3 sentences. Be concise."

3. Match the feedback against Corrections (p. 35). Put each flagged pattern into Box 1.
4. Target one pattern for the week. Re-record at week's end and check if it dropped.

Do this once a week at most — the daily loop stays offline and short.

PART I · THE SYSTEM / MODULE 6

Metrics

Score once per week using a 60-second recording. Use the same prompt twice per month so progress is visible.

1. Fluency Score (0–10)

Score	Description
0–2	Single words or broken phrases only.
3–4	Can speak, but stops often and restarts.
5–6	Understandable short answers with pauses.
7–8	Smooth common-topic speaking with minor pauses.
9–10	Flexible, natural, and professional under pressure.

2. Hesitation Score

Count silent pauses longer than 2 seconds in a 60-second answer.

Pauses	Score
10+	1
7–9	3
4–6	5
2–3	7
0–1	9–10

3. Longest Fluent Run

Measure the longest stretch of speech (in seconds) with no pause longer than 2 seconds. This single number captures fluency better than a self-score — aim to grow it week over week.

Longest run	Reading
under 5s	starts break quickly
5–10s	full sentences forming
10–20s	connected speech
20s+	sustained, conversational

4. Grammar Score

Track only high-frequency errors that affect clarity.

- tense control,
- plural/singular,
- prepositions,
- article use,
- verb patterns,
- Malayalam-transfer sentence order.

5. Accent Score (General American)

Rate how minimally-marked you sound. Prosody first — it carries the most weight.

Area	Question
rhythm	Strong beats on content words, small words reduced to "uh"?
stress	Is the main syllable strong, and the right word stressed in the sentence?
t/d	Alveolar (tip on the ridge), not retroflex/curled-back?
v/w & th	Distinct v/w; th not turning into t/d/s?
r & vowels	Rhotic r (car, work) without rolling; diphthongs glided, not flat?
blending	Words linked and smooth (flap-T, gonna/wanna), not word-by-word?

Quick self-check: record one sentence, play the same words on a US text-to-speech, and find one gap. Fewer gaps over time = less-marked accent.

6. Retrieval Speed

Pick 10 cards (frameworks, chunks, or expressions). For each, start a spoken sentence within 3 seconds.

Instant Starts	Retrieval Score
0–2	2
3–4	4
5–6	6
7–8	8
9–10	10

Weekly Self-Assessment Checklist

- ☐ I completed at least 5 short sessions.
- ☐ I recorded one 60-second answer.
- ☐ I reduced at least one repeated mistake.
- ☐ I used 10+ frameworks/chunks in real or simulated speech.
- ☐ I practiced one pronunciation target.
- ☐ My longest fluent run held steady or grew.
- ☐ I can name one visible improvement.

The Only ROI Rule

A card is successful only when it appears in your real speech. Passive recognition does not count — that is why every card graduates through the spaced-repetition ladder, not by being read once.

PART II · SPEAKING TOOLKIT / MODULE 7

Frameworks

Each framework is a sentence engine — a fixed opening that lets you start speaking before you have planned the whole sentence. Learn one in under 60 seconds: read it, say both examples aloud, then build one new sentence of your own. The goal is speed of starting, not memorizing.

Opinion

F001 **I think…**

When you want to share your view without sounding too forceful.

- I think we should test this before the demo.
- I think the second design looks cleaner.

Drill Say one thing you think about your current project.

F002 **In my opinion…**

When you want to clearly mark something as your personal view.

- In my opinion, the meeting could have been an email.
- In my opinion, mornings are better for deep work.

Drill Give your opinion on a movie you watched recently.

F003 **From my experience…**

When your point comes from things you've actually done.

- From my experience, users skip long forms.
- From my experience, weekend deployments cause stress.

Drill Share one lesson from your work, starting with this frame.

Stating a point

F004 **The main point is…**

When you want to cut to the core of what matters.

- The main point is that we missed the deadline.
- The main point is keeping the customer happy.

Drill State the main point of your day in one sentence.

F005 **The problem is…**

When you need to name the obstacle clearly.

- The problem is that the server keeps crashing.
- The problem is we don't have enough time.

Drill Name one problem you're facing right now.

F006 **The best option is…**

When you're recommending the strongest choice among many.

- The best option is to launch next week instead.
- The best option is to hire one more person.

Drill Pick a decision and say what the best option is.

F007 **It depends on…**

When the answer isn't fixed and varies with conditions.

- It depends on how much budget we have.
- It depends on whether the client agrees.

Drill Answer a question with "It depends on…" and one condition.

Explaining

F008 **What I mean is…**

When you want to make your point clearer or rephrase it.

- What I mean is we should slow down, not stop.
- What I mean is the design needs more contrast.

Drill Say something, then restart it with "What I mean is…".

F009 **Let me explain…**

When you're about to give the background or reasoning.

- Let me explain why the report was late.
- Let me explain how this feature works.

Drill Pick a topic and start explaining it with this frame.

F010 **For example…**

When you want to back up a point with a concrete case.

- For example, last month we lost two clients.
- For example, you can press Ctrl+S to save.

Drill Make a claim, then give a "For example…" to support it.

F011 **The reason is…**

When you want to give the cause behind something.

- The reason is the supplier raised their prices.
- The reason is I had a doctor's appointment.

Drill State a decision, then explain "The reason is…".

Reasoning & contrast

F012 **That's why…**

When you want to connect a cause to its result.

- That's why I came in early today.
- That's why we switched to the new tool.

Drill Mention a cause, then add the result with "That's why…".

F013 **However…**

When you want to add a contrasting point.

- However, the price is still too high for us.
- However, the team finished it on time.

Drill State something, then add a contrast with "However…".

F014 **On the other hand…**

When you want to present the opposite side of an argument.

- On the other hand, working remotely saves commute time.
- On the other hand, the cheaper plan has fewer features.

Drill Give one view, then the other side with this frame.

F015 **Even though…**

When something is true despite an obstacle.

- Even though it rained, we still finished the site visit.
- Even though I was tired, I joined the call.

Drill Make a sentence with "Even though…" about today.

F016 **Compared to…**

When you want to measure one thing against another.

- Compared to last year, our sales doubled.
- Compared to the old app, this one is much faster.

Drill Compare two things you use with this frame.

Suggesting & deciding

F017 **I suggest…**

When you want to offer an idea lightly.

- I suggest we take a short break now.
- I suggest testing it on a small group first.

Drill Suggest one improvement for your team.

F018 **I recommend…**

When you want to advise something with confidence.

- I recommend reading the contract twice.
- I recommend the window seat for that flight.

Drill Recommend a book, tool, or place using this frame.

F019 **We should consider…**

When you want the group to weigh an option.

- We should consider moving the deadline.
- We should consider a different vendor.

Drill Raise one option your team should think about.

F020 **We need to decide…**

When a choice has to be made and you want to push for it.

- We need to decide who leads the project.
- We need to decide the budget by Friday.

Drill Name one decision your team needs to make.

F021 **I'd prefer…**

When you want to state your preference politely.

- I'd prefer to meet in the morning.
- I'd prefer tea over coffee, actually.

Drill State a preference between two options.

Agreeing & disagreeing

F022 **I agree with…**

When you want to support someone's point.

- I agree with your plan to launch early.
- I agree with what Priya said about the budget.

Drill Agree with one thing someone said today.

F023 **I disagree with…**

When you want to push back clearly but respectfully.

- I disagree with cutting the testing phase.
- I disagree with that price estimate.

Drill Disagree with a common opinion using this frame.

F024 **I partly agree…**

When you accept some of an idea but not all of it.

- I partly agree, but the timeline worries me.
- I partly agree; the plan needs more detail.

Drill Partly agree with a statement, then add your reservation.

F025 **That makes sense…**

When you want to show you follow and accept the logic.

- That makes sense, let's go with it.
- That makes sense now that you explained it.

Drill React to an explanation with "That makes sense...".

F026 **I see it differently…**

When you want to offer another view without conflict.

- I see it differently; I think users want fewer steps.
- I see it differently, but I get your point.

Drill Give a different view on something with this frame.

Clarifying & repairing

F027 **I'm not sure…**

When you want to admit uncertainty honestly.

- I'm not sure that's the right number.
- I'm not sure I can finish it today.

Drill Express doubt about one plan using this frame.

F028 **Could you clarify…?**

When you need someone to make something clearer.

- Could you clarify which file you mean?
- Could you clarify what the deadline is?

Drill Ask a real clarifying question ending in "?".

F029 **Do you mean…?**

When you want to check you understood correctly.

- Do you mean the Friday report or the Monday one?
- Do you mean we should cancel the trip?

Drill Restate someone's point as a "Do you mean...?" question.

F030 **Just to confirm…**

When you want to lock in shared understanding.

- Just to confirm, the meeting is at 3 PM.
- Just to confirm, you'll send the invoice today?

Drill Confirm one detail of a plan with this frame.

F031 **Let me rephrase that…**

When your first attempt came out badly and you want a do-over.

- Let me rephrase that, I didn't mean it that way.
- Let me rephrase that more simply.

Drill Say a clumsy sentence, then fix it with this frame.

F032 **Correct me if I'm wrong…**

When you want to state something but stay open to correction.

- Correct me if I'm wrong, the launch is next Tuesday.
- Correct me if I'm wrong, you handle the south region?

Drill State an assumption and invite correction with this frame.

Work & status

F033 **The priority is…**

When you want to flag what matters most right now.

- The priority is fixing the login bug.
- The priority is getting client approval.

Drill Name your top priority for the week.

F034 **The deadline is…**

When you need to state when something is due.

- The deadline is this Friday at noon.
- The deadline is the end of the month.

Drill State a real deadline you have right now.

F035 **The next step is…**

When you want to move a plan forward.

- The next step is to share it with the client.
- The next step is to test on real devices.

Drill Say the next step in something you're working on.

F036 **I'm working on…**

When you want to report what's in progress.

- I'm working on the quarterly report.
- I'm working on improving my pronunciation.

Drill Say what you're working on today.

F037 **I've finished…**

When you want to report something is done.

- I've finished the first draft of the proposal.
- I've finished testing the payment flow.

Drill Report one thing you've finished recently.

F038 **I'm blocked on…**

When something is stopping your progress.

- I'm blocked on the design approval.
- I'm blocked on access to the database.

Drill Name one thing you're blocked on right now.

Narration & time

F039 **Recently…**

When you want to talk about the near past.

- Recently, I started learning to cook.
- Recently, our team grew to ten people.

Drill Share one recent change in your life.

F040 **These days…**

When you describe an ongoing current situation.

- These days, I work mostly from home.
- These days, everyone uses video calls.

Drill Describe a current habit with "These days…".

F041 **At first…**

When you want to begin telling how something started.

- At first, I found the job difficult.
- At first, the app kept crashing.

Drill Start a short story about a change with this frame.

F042 **After that…**

When you want to continue a sequence of events.

- After that, we moved to a bigger office.
- After that, the issue disappeared.

Drill Add the next event in a story with "After that...".

F043 **In the end…**

When you want to give the outcome of a story.

- In the end, the client signed the deal.
- In the end, we chose the simpler option.

Drill Finish a short story with "In the end...".

F044 **I used to…**

When you describe a past habit that has changed.

- I used to commute two hours every day.
- I used to be afraid of speaking up.

Drill Say one thing you used to do but no longer do.

Importance & ability

F045 **It's important to…**

When you want to stress what matters.

- It's important to reply to clients quickly.
- It's important to take breaks during the day.

Drill Say one thing it's important to do at work.

F046 **It's better to…**

When you want to recommend the wiser choice.

- It's better to ask than to guess.
- It's better to launch small and improve later.

Drill Give advice with "It's better to...".

F047 **I'm trying to…**

When you want to describe an effort in progress.

- I'm trying to speak more slowly and clearly.
- I'm trying to finish this by tonight.

Drill Say one thing you're trying to do these days.

F048 **I'm able to…**

When you want to state what you can do.

- I'm able to handle the client calls now.
- I'm able to join the meeting after lunch.

Drill State one new thing you're able to do.

Summarizing

F049 **To summarize…**

When you want to wrap up a longer point.

- To summarize, we're on track but slightly over budget.
- To summarize, the plan works with small changes.

Drill Summarize your day in one sentence.

F050 **In short…**

When you want to give a quick bottom line.

- In short, we need more time.
- In short, the customer is happy.

Drill Give the short version of a long story.

F051 **Overall…**

When you want to give a general judgment.

- Overall, the event went well.
- Overall, the team did a great job.

Drill Give an overall verdict on something you tried.

F052 **The point is…**

When you want to drive home your core message.

- The point is we can't keep delaying.
- The point is the customer comes first.

Drill State the point you most want someone to remember.

Questions

F053 **What do you think…?**

When you want to invite someone's opinion.

- What do you think about moving the date?
- What do you think of this design?

Drill Ask someone for their view with this frame.

F054 **What's the next step…?**

When you want to push a plan forward as a question.

- What's the next step on the contract?
- What's the next step after testing?

Drill Ask about the next step in a project.

F055 **What's blocking this…?**

When you want to find out what's holding something up.

- What's blocking this from going live?
- What's blocking this approval?

Drill Ask what's blocking one of your tasks.

F056 **How can I help…?**

When you want to offer support.

- How can I help with the launch?
- How can I help you finish on time?

Drill Offer help to a colleague using this frame.

PART II · SPEAKING TOOLKIT / MODULE 8

Chunks & Collocations

Fluency lives in chunks, not single words. These are high-frequency multi-word pieces you can retrieve whole, so you build sentences faster with fewer pauses. Don't memorize silently — say each one inside a real sentence about your life or work.

Decisions & Work

V001 **make a decision**
to decide something
- We need to make a decision about the budget before Friday.

Drill Say a true sentence about a decision you made this week.

V002 **take responsibility for**
to accept that something is your job or your fault (followed by a noun or -ing)
- I'll take responsibility for the report and send it out today.

Drill Say one thing you take responsibility for at work or home.

V003 **come up with**
to think of or produce an idea or plan
- Can you come up with a few names for the new project?

Drill Say a true sentence about an idea you came up with recently.

V004 **run into a problem**
to unexpectedly hit a difficulty
- We ran into a problem when the file wouldn't open.

Drill Say a sentence about a problem you ran into lately.

V005 **sort it out**
to fix or organize a problem or situation
- Don't worry, I'll sort it out before the meeting.

Drill Say something you need to sort out this week.

V006 **deal with**
to handle a problem, task, or person (followed by a noun)
- I have to deal with a few emails before I can leave.

Drill Say one thing you have to deal with today.

V007 **look into it**
to investigate or check something
- That's a good question — let me look into it and get back to you.

Drill Say a true sentence using "look into it" about a question you have.

V008 **go over (the details)**
to review or check something carefully
- Let's go over the details one more time before we send it.

Drill Say something you want to go over before you finish it.

V009 **set up a meeting**
to arrange or schedule a meeting
- I'll set up a meeting with the team for Monday morning.

Drill Say a sentence about a meeting you need to set up.

V010 **push back the deadline**
to move a deadline to a later date
- Can we push back the deadline by a couple of days?

Drill Say a true sentence about pushing back a deadline.

V011 **take care of it**
to handle or do something
- Leave it with me — I'll take care of it this afternoon.

Drill Say something you'll take care of today.

V012 **fall behind**
to be slower than you should be; to be late with work
- I fell behind on my emails while I was on vacation.

Drill Say a true sentence about falling behind on something.

V013 **catch up on**
to do work you missed or got behind on (followed by a noun)
- I need to catch up on my reading this weekend.

Drill Say something you need to catch up on.

V014 **get on the same page**
to reach a shared understanding with someone
- Let's talk first so we get on the same page about the plan.

Drill Say a sentence about getting on the same page with someone.

V015 **touch base**
to make brief contact to share an update
- Let's touch base tomorrow to see how it's going.

Drill Say someone you need to touch base with this week.

V016 **wrap up**
to finish or end something
- Let's wrap up this call — we've covered everything.

Drill Say something you want to wrap up today.

V017 **follow up on**
to check on or continue something started earlier (followed by a noun)
- I'll follow up on that email if I don't hear back.

Drill Say a true sentence about something you need to follow up on.

V018 **get back to you**
to reply or respond later
- Let me check the dates and I'll get back to you by tonight.

Drill Say a sentence promising to get back to someone.

V019 **keep you posted**
to keep someone updated with news
- I'll keep you posted as soon as I know more.

Drill Say a sentence telling someone you'll keep them posted.

V020 **work it out**
to solve or figure something out
- We had a disagreement, but we worked it out in the end.

Drill Say a true sentence about something you worked out.

Opinion & Discourse

V021 **to be honest**
used to introduce a frank or true opinion
- To be honest, I'm not sure that's the best idea.

Drill Say a true opinion starting with "To be honest...".

V022 **the thing is**
used to introduce a key point or problem
- I'd love to come, but the thing is, I'm already busy that day.

Drill Say a sentence starting with "The thing is...".

V023 **as far as I know**
based on what you know, though you might be wrong
- As far as I know, the office is closed on Monday.

Drill Say a true sentence starting with "As far as I know...".

V024 **it depends**
the answer changes based on the situation
- "Will you come?" "It depends — what time does it start?"

Drill Answer a question with "It depends" and explain why.

V025 **the way I see it**
in my personal opinion
- The way I see it, we should just start over.

Drill Say an opinion starting with "The way I see it...".

V026 **more or less**
almost; roughly; not exactly but close
- The project is more or less finished now.

Drill Say a true sentence using "more or less".

V027 **for the most part**
mostly; in most cases
- For the most part, I enjoy my job.

Drill Say something that is true "for the most part".

V028 **on second thought**
after reconsidering; having changed your mind
- On second thought, let's not go out tonight.

Drill Say a sentence where you change your mind with "On second thought".

V029 **at the end of the day**
when everything is considered; ultimately
- At the end of the day, what matters is that everyone's safe.

Drill Say a true sentence starting with "At the end of the day...".

V030 **in the long run**
over a long period; eventually
- Saving a little now will help in the long run.

Drill Say something that pays off "in the long run".

Time & Sequence

V031 **as soon as possible**
at the earliest possible time
- Please send me the file as soon as possible.

Drill Say something you need to do as soon as possible.

V032 **right away**
immediately
- I noticed the mistake and fixed it right away.

Drill Say a true sentence about something you did right away.

V033 **in advance**
before a time or event; ahead of need
- Let me know in advance if you can't make it.

Drill Say something you like to plan in advance.

V034 **ahead of time**
before the planned or expected time
- I prepared everything ahead of time so I wouldn't rush.

Drill Say a true sentence using "ahead of time".

V035 **from now on**
starting now and continuing into the future
- From now on, I'll check my emails first thing in the morning.

Drill Say a habit you'll start "from now on".

V036 **sooner or later**
at some point; eventually
- Sooner or later, you'll have to make a choice.

Drill Say something that will happen "sooner or later".

V037 **for the time being**
for now; temporarily
- For the time being, we'll keep things the way they are.

Drill Say a true sentence using "for the time being".

V038 **in the meantime**
in the time before something else happens
- The fix is coming, but in the meantime, please be patient.

Drill Say a sentence using "in the meantime".

Everyday High-Frequency

V039 **a bit of a**
somewhat of a; a slight (followed by a noun)
- It's a bit of a long story, but I'll keep it short.

Drill Say something that is "a bit of a" problem or surprise.

V040 **kind of**
somewhat; a little; sort of
- I'm kind of tired today, so I'll head home early.

Drill Say a true sentence using "kind of".

V041 **a couple of**
two, or a small number (followed by a plural noun)
- I'll be ready in a couple of minutes.

Drill Say a sentence with "a couple of" about your day.

V042 **a lot of**
many or much (followed by a noun)
- There's a lot of work to do before the launch.

Drill Say a true sentence using "a lot of".

V043 **plenty of**
more than enough (followed by a noun)
- Don't rush — we have plenty of time.

Drill Say something you have plenty of.

V044 **run out of**
to use up all of something so none is left (followed by a noun)
- We've run out of milk, so I'll buy some.

Drill Say a true sentence about running out of something.

V045 **end up (doing)**
to finally be in a situation or do something (often unplanned; + -ing)
- We ended up staying home because of the rain.

Drill Say a sentence about something you ended up doing.

V046 **be about to**
to be on the point of doing something (followed by a verb)
- I was about to call you when you texted.

Drill Say something you're about to do.

V047 **feel like (doing)**
to want to do something (followed by a noun or -ing)
- I feel like going for a walk this evening.

Drill Say what you feel like doing right now.

V048 **look forward to**
to be excited about a future event (followed by a noun or -ing)
- I'm looking forward to seeing you next week.

Drill Say a true sentence about something you look forward to.

V049 **get used to**
to become familiar or comfortable with something (followed by a noun or -ing)
- It took me a while to get used to the new schedule.

Drill Say something you had to get used to.

V050 **be supposed to**
to be expected or required to do something (followed by a verb)
- I'm supposed to finish this by tomorrow.

Drill Say something you're supposed to do today.

V051 **make sense**
to be logical or easy to understand
- That explanation makes sense now, thanks.

Drill Say a sentence about something that makes sense to you.

V052 **make sure**
to check or ensure that something happens (often followed by "to" or "that")
- Make sure to lock the door when you leave.

Drill Say something you'll make sure to do.

V053 **keep in mind**
to remember or consider something (often followed by "that")
- Keep in mind that the shops close early on Sundays.

Drill Say a true sentence starting with "Keep in mind...".

V054 **by the way**
used to add a side comment or new topic
- By the way, did you get my message?

Drill Add a side comment to a sentence using "by the way".

V055 **in case**
as a precaution; if something happens (followed by a clause)
- Take an umbrella in case it rains.

Drill Say something you do "in case" of something.

V056 **no matter what**
whatever happens; regardless
- I'll be there for you no matter what.

Drill Say something you'll do "no matter what".

V057 **as well**
also; too (usually at the end of a sentence)
- I'll bring the drinks, and some snacks as well.

Drill Say a sentence ending in "as well".

V058 **at least**
not less than; or used to mention one good point
- It was a long day, but at least we finished on time.

Drill Say a true sentence using "at least".

Social & Repair

V059 **never mind**
it doesn't matter; forget what I said
- Never mind, I'll figure it out myself.

Drill Say a sentence using "never mind" to drop a point.

V060 **my bad**
an informal way to admit a small mistake
- My bad — I sent it to the wrong person.

Drill Say a sentence admitting a small mistake with "my bad".

V061 **fair enough**
that's a reasonable point; I accept that
- "I'd rather stay in tonight." "Fair enough."

Drill Respond to a reason with "Fair enough" and add a line.

V062 **that works**
that's fine with me; that's acceptable
- "How about three o'clock?" "That works for me."

Drill Agree to a plan using "that works".

V063 **sounds good**
that's a good idea; I agree
- "Let's grab lunch later." "Sounds good."

Drill Agree to something with "sounds good".

V064 **let me think**
asking for a moment to consider
- Let me think — I'll have an answer for you in a second.

Drill Pause before answering a question with "let me think".

V065 **hang on a second**
wait a short moment
- Hang on a second, I need to grab a pen.

Drill Say a sentence asking someone to wait with "hang on a second".

V066 **take your time**
there's no need to hurry
- Take your time — we're not in a rush.

Drill Tell someone to "take your time" in a real situation.

V067 **no rush**
there's no hurry
- Send it whenever — no rush.

Drill Reassure someone with "no rush".

V068 **go ahead**
giving permission to start or continue
- "Can I ask you something?" "Sure, go ahead."

Drill Give someone permission using "go ahead".

Problem & Cause

V069 **that's why**
that is the reason; introduces a result
- The train was late — that's why I missed the meeting.

Drill Explain a result with "that's why".

V070 **due to**
because of (followed by a noun)
- The flight was delayed due to bad weather.

Drill Say a true sentence using "due to".

V071 **lead to**
to cause or result in something (followed by a noun)
- Skipping breakfast can lead to low energy.

Drill Say something that can "lead to" a result.

V072 **result in**
to cause a particular outcome (followed by a noun)
- The mistake resulted in a big delay.

Drill Say a sentence where one thing "results in" another.

V073 **on purpose**
deliberately; intentionally
- I didn't break it on purpose — it was an accident.

Drill Say a true sentence using "on purpose".

V074 **by mistake**

accidentally; not on purpose

- I deleted the file by mistake.

Drill Say something you did "by mistake".

V075 **work out (well)**

to happen successfully in the end

- Everything worked out well in the end.

Drill Say a true sentence about something that worked out.

V076 **end up with**

to finally have something (often unplanned; followed by a noun)

- We ended up with way too much food at the party.

Drill Say a sentence about what you ended up with.

V077 **be stuck on**

to be unable to make progress with something (followed by a noun)

- I'm stuck on this question — can you help?

Drill Say something you're stuck on right now.

V078 **make progress**

to move forward or improve toward a goal

- I'm slowly making progress on my English.

Drill Say a true sentence about progress you're making.

PART II · SPEAKING TOOLKIT / MODULE 9

Expressions

These are conversation shortcuts — ready phrases whose social job is already packaged, so you don't build them word by word. A key group is **bridges**: phrases that buy you a second so you keep talking instead of pausing silently. Learn one in under 60 seconds and use it in a real reply.

Bridges (buy time)

E001 **That's a good question.** BRIDGE · NEUTRAL
Someone asks you something you weren't ready for and you need a moment before answering.
Drill Say it, then begin your real answer without pausing.

E002 **Let me think for a second.** BRIDGE · NEUTRAL
You openly take a beat to gather your thoughts instead of going silent.
Drill Say it, count one breath, then start your point.

E003 **How should I put this?** BRIDGE · NEUTRAL
You're searching for the right words to phrase something delicate or complex.
Drill Say it, then give your first attempt at the wording.

E004 **The way I see it…** BRIDGE · NEUTRAL
You signal an opinion is coming and ease into stating your view.
Drill Say it, then finish with one clear opinion.

E005 **What I'm trying to say is…** BRIDGE · NEUTRAL
You've rambled a bit and want to land on your main point cleanly.
Drill Say it, then state your point in one sentence.

E006 **Let me put it this way.** BRIDGE · NEUTRAL
Your first explanation didn't land, so you reframe it more simply.
Drill Say it, then give a simpler version of your idea.

E007 **Off the top of my head…** BRIDGE · CASUAL
You give a quick, unprepared answer without committing to exact details.
Drill Say it, then offer one rough answer or number.

E008 **Good question — let me think.** BRIDGE · NEUTRAL
You acknowledge a tough question and buy time in the same breath.
Drill Say it, then start answering after a short pause.

Reacting & agreeing

E009 **That makes sense.** REACT · NEUTRAL
Someone explained something and you signal you understood and accept it.
Drill Say it after a colleague explains a plan.

E010 **Fair enough.** REACT · CASUAL
You accept someone's point even if it's not exactly what you wanted.
Drill Say it in response to a reasonable pushback.

E011 **Good point.** REACT · NEUTRAL
Someone raises something useful you hadn't fully considered.
Drill Say it, then build one sentence on their point.

E012 **Exactly.** REACT · CASUAL
Someone says exactly what you were thinking and you agree strongly.
Drill Say it the moment someone matches your view.

E013 **That's true.** REACT · NEUTRAL
You confirm a fact or observation someone just made.
Drill Say it, then add a short related thought.

E014 **I see your point.** REACT · NEUTRAL
You acknowledge someone's reasoning before possibly adding your own view.
Drill Say it, then add "but..." with your angle.

E015 **I completely agree.** REACT · NEUTRAL
You back someone's idea fully and want it to be clear.
Drill Say it firmly after someone makes a proposal.

E016 **I partly agree.** REACT · NEUTRAL
You're with someone on part of their idea but not all of it.
Drill Say it, then name the part you agree with.

E017 **I see it differently.** REACT · PROFESSIONAL
You politely signal disagreement before giving your own view.
Drill Say it, then state your different opinion.

E018 **I'm not so sure about that.** REACT · NEUTRAL
You softly push back on an idea you have doubts about.
Drill Say it, then give one reason for your doubt.

Clarifying & repairing

E019 **Could you clarify that?** CLARIFY · PROFESSIONAL
Something wasn't clear and you ask for it to be explained further.
Drill Say it, then point to the exact part you mean.

E020 **Can you give an example?** CLARIFY · NEUTRAL
An idea is too abstract and a concrete example would help you follow it.
Drill Say it after hearing a vague explanation.

E021 **What do you mean exactly?** CLARIFY · NEUTRAL
A word or statement was ambiguous and you need the precise meaning.
Drill Say it, then wait for them to narrow it down.

E022 **Let me rephrase that.** CLARIFY · NEUTRAL
You realize your own wording was confusing and want to fix it.
Drill Say it, then say the same idea more simply.

E023 **Sorry, I wasn't clear.** CLARIFY · NEUTRAL
You take responsibility when someone misunderstood what you said.
Drill Say it, then restate your point cleanly.

E024 **Correct me if I'm wrong.** CLARIFY · NEUTRAL
You check your understanding by inviting the other person to fix it.
Drill Say it, then state what you think is true.

E025 **Just to confirm...** CLARIFY · PROFESSIONAL
You repeat back a detail to make sure you got it right.
Drill Say it, then read back the date, number, or task.

E026 **Just to be clear...** CLARIFY · NEUTRAL
You restate something important to remove any doubt.
Drill Say it, then state the key point in one line.

E027 **Does that make sense?** CLARIFY · NEUTRAL
You check that your explanation came across after saying it.
Drill Say it after explaining something tricky.

E028 **Let me make sure I understand.** CLARIFY · PROFESSIONAL
You slow down to confirm you've followed a complex request.
Drill Say it, then summarize what you heard.

Status & updates

E029 **I have an update.** STATUS · NEUTRAL
You open a message or moment to share fresh progress on a task.
Drill Say it, then give the update in one sentence.

E030 **I've finished this.** STATUS · NEUTRAL
You report that a task is fully complete.
Drill Say it, then name what's done.

E031 **I'm still working on it.** STATUS · NEUTRAL
A task is in progress and you let someone know it's not done yet.
Drill Say it when asked for a status.

E032 **I'm blocked on this.** STATUS · PROFESSIONAL
Something is stopping your progress and you need help to move on.
Drill Say it, then name what's blocking you.

E033 **I need more time.** STATUS · NEUTRAL
You can't finish by the original deadline and say so early.
Drill Say it, then propose a new time.

E034 **I can finish it by tomorrow.** STATUS · NEUTRAL
You commit to a clear deadline for completing the work.
Drill Say it, then confirm the exact day.

E035 **I'll get back to you.** STATUS · NEUTRAL
You don't have the answer now but promise to follow up.
Drill Say it, then say roughly when.

E036 **It should work now.** STATUS · NEUTRAL
You've made a fix and signal it's likely resolved.
Drill Say it, then ask them to check.

E037 **I'll fix it.** STATUS · NEUTRAL
You take ownership of a problem and commit to solving it.
Drill Say it as soon as an issue comes up.

E038 **I already fixed it.** STATUS · NEUTRAL
A problem was raised that you've already taken care of.
Drill Say it, then say what you changed.

Meetings & calls

E039 **Can everyone hear me?** MEETING · NEUTRAL
You check your audio at the start of a call before speaking.
Drill Say it, then wait for a thumbs-up.

E040 **You're on mute.** MEETING · CASUAL
Someone is talking but their mic is off and no one can hear them.
Drill Say it the moment you see lips moving with no sound.

E041 **You're breaking up.** MEETING · CASUAL
Someone's connection is poor and their voice keeps cutting out.
Drill Say it, then ask them to repeat.

E042 **Could you speak a little slower?** MEETING · PROFESSIONAL
Someone is talking too fast for you to follow comfortably.
Drill Say it politely, then keep listening.

E043 **I missed the last part.** MEETING · NEUTRAL
You lost the end of what someone said and want it again.
Drill Say it, then name the part you caught.

E044 **Can you repeat that?** MEETING · NEUTRAL
You didn't catch something and ask for it once more.
Drill Say it instead of staying silent when lost.

E045 **Let's get started.** MEETING · NEUTRAL
You kick off a meeting and signal it's time to begin.
Drill Say it, then name the first topic.

E046 **Let's move on.** MEETING · NEUTRAL
A topic is done and you steer the group to the next one.
Drill Say it, then state the next item.

E047 **Can I add something?** MEETING · NEUTRAL
You want to contribute a point during a discussion.
Drill Say it, then make your point briefly.

E048 **Sorry to interrupt.** MEETING · NEUTRAL
You need to break in while someone is speaking.
Drill Say it, then say your one urgent point.

E049 **Go ahead.** MEETING · CASUAL
You give someone the floor to speak or continue.
Drill Say it when two people start at once.

E050 **Let's wrap up.** MEETING · NEUTRAL
Time is short and you move the meeting toward closing.
Drill Say it, then summarize the next steps.

Scheduling

E051 **Can we reschedule?** SCHEDULE · NEUTRAL
You can't make the planned time and want to find another.
Drill Say it, then suggest a new slot.

E052 **Can we move it earlier?** SCHEDULE · NEUTRAL
You'd prefer the meeting to happen sooner than planned.
Drill Say it, then propose a specific time.

E053 **Can we do a quick call?** SCHEDULE · CASUAL
Something is easier to sort out by voice than by text.
Drill Say it, then offer two time options.

E054 **I'm running late.** SCHEDULE · CASUAL
You'll arrive or join after the start and warn people ahead.
Drill Say it, then give your real arrival time.

E055 **I'll join in five minutes.** SCHEDULE · NEUTRAL
You're slightly delayed for a call and give a clear estimate.
Drill Say it, then actually join on time.

E056 **I have a conflict at that time.** SCHEDULE · PROFESSIONAL
The proposed time clashes with something already booked.
Drill Say it, then offer when you're free.

E057 **Does that time work for you?** SCHEDULE · NEUTRAL
You suggest a time and check it suits the other person.
Drill Say it right after proposing a slot.

E058 **Let's set a deadline.** SCHEDULE · PROFESSIONAL
A task has no end date and you push to agree on one.
Drill Say it, then propose a specific date.

Asking & offering

E059 **What do you suggest?** ASK/OFFER · NEUTRAL
You're unsure how to proceed and ask for the other person's idea.
Drill Say it after describing the problem.

E060 **What would you recommend?** ASK/OFFER · PROFESSIONAL
You ask for advice from someone with more experience.
Drill Say it, then listen without interrupting.

E061 **What are the options?** ASK/OFFER · NEUTRAL
You want to see the choices before deciding anything.
Drill Say it, then weigh the answers aloud.

E062 **How can I help?** ASK/OFFER · NEUTRAL
Someone seems stuck and you offer your support.
Drill Say it when a teammate looks overloaded.

E063 **Do you need a hand?** ASK/OFFER · CASUAL
You offer practical help with a task in a friendly way.
Drill Say it, then name what you can take on.

E064 **Let me know if you need anything.** ASK/OFFER · NEUTRAL
You leave the door open to help without pushing.
Drill Say it at the end of a handover.

E065 **Can you guide me through it?** ASK/OFFER · NEUTRAL
You want someone to walk you step by step through a process.
Drill Say it, then follow along and take notes.

E066 **Can you show me once?** ASK/OFFER · CASUAL
You'll learn faster by seeing it done one time.
Drill Say it, then watch and repeat it yourself.

Mistakes & social

E067 **My bad.** SOCIAL · CASUAL
You own a small mistake quickly and casually.
Drill Say it, then say what you'll do next.

E068 **Sorry for the delay.** SOCIAL · NEUTRAL
You apologize for a late reply or late delivery.
Drill Say it, then give the update or item.

E069 **Sorry for the confusion.** SOCIAL · NEUTRAL
A mix-up happened and you smooth it over before clarifying.
Drill Say it, then state the correct version.

E070 **Thanks for your patience.** SOCIAL · PROFESSIONAL
Someone waited on you and you acknowledge it warmly.
Drill Say it after a delay you caused.

E071 **Thanks for the reminder.** SOCIAL · NEUTRAL
Someone nudged you about something you'd forgotten.
Drill Say it, then act on the reminder.

E072 **I missed that.** SOCIAL · NEUTRAL
You admit you overlooked something without making excuses.
Drill Say it, then say how you'll handle it.

E073 **No worries.** SOCIAL · CASUAL
Someone apologizes and you put them at ease.
Drill Say it warmly when someone says sorry.

E074 **It happens.** SOCIAL · CASUAL
You reassure someone that a small mistake is normal.
Drill Say it when a teammate slips up.

Closing & moving forward

E075 **Keep me posted.** CLOSING · NEUTRAL
You ask to be kept informed of any new developments.
Drill Say it at the end of a handoff.

E076 **I'll keep you updated.** CLOSING · NEUTRAL
You promise to share progress as things move along.
Drill Say it, then actually send the next update.

E077 **Let's follow up tomorrow.** CLOSING · NEUTRAL
You park a topic and agree to return to it the next day.
Drill Say it, then set the rough time.

E078 **Sounds good.** CLOSING · CASUAL
You agree to a plan and signal you're on board.
Drill Say it when a plan is settled.

E079 **Works for me.** CLOSING · CASUAL
A proposed time or plan suits you and you confirm it.
Drill Say it right after a time is suggested.

E080 **Let's touch base later.** CLOSING · NEUTRAL
You agree to reconnect soon without fixing exact details now.
Drill Say it, then suggest a rough time.

PART II · SPEAKING TOOLKIT / MODULE 10

Corrections

These are the highest-frequency Malayalam/Indian-English transfer errors — the ones that most mark speech as non-native. Learn the *pattern* behind each, not just the sentence. One card takes under 60 seconds: say the wrong form once, the correct form three times, then build one new sentence.

C001 ~~discuss about~~ → **discuss**

"Discuss" is already transitive and carries the meaning of "talk about," so adding "about" is redundant.

- Let's discuss the budget tomorrow.
- We discussed the new plan for an hour.

C002 ~~am having a car~~ → **have a car**

"Have" for possession is a stative verb, so it isn't used in the continuous. Reserve "having" for activities like having lunch or having a meeting.

- I have a car.
- She has two brothers.

C003 ~~one of my friend~~ → **one of my friends**

"One of" picks a single item from a group, so the noun that follows must be plural.

- One of my friends lives in Dubai.
- He is one of the best players on the team.

C004 ~~I am agree~~ → **I agree**

"Agree" is a verb, not an adjective, so it doesn't take the linking verb "am." You simply conjugate it directly.

- I agree with you.
- We agreed on a price.

C005 ~~I didn't went~~ → **I didn't go**

After the auxiliary "did/didn't," the main verb stays in its base form; the past tense is already carried by "did."

- I didn't go to the party.
- She didn't call me back.

C006 ~~She don't know~~ → **She doesn't know**

Third-person singular (he/she/it) takes "doesn't," not "don't," in the present tense.

- She doesn't know the answer.
- He doesn't eat meat.

C007 ~~He go to office~~ → **He goes to the office**

Third-person singular adds "-s" to the verb ("goes"), and a specific workplace usually needs the article "the."

- He goes to the office at nine.
- She goes to the gym every morning.

C008 ~~I am working here since 2020~~ → **I have been working here since 2020**

An action that started in the past and continues now uses the present perfect continuous, not the present continuous.

- I have been working here since 2020.
- They have been living in Chennai since last year.

C009 ~~I know him from 5 years~~ → **I have known him for 5 years**

Duration up to now takes the present perfect with "for" (a length of time), not "from."

- I have known him for five years.
- We have been married for ten years.

C010 ~~Yesterday I have gone~~ → **Yesterday I went**

A finished time word like "yesterday" requires the simple past, not the present perfect, which is for unspecified time.

- Yesterday I went to the market.
- Last week she finished the project.

C011 ~~I said him~~ → **I told him**

"Tell" takes a person as its object ("told him"); "say" does not — you say something to someone.

- I told him the truth.
- She told me a story.

C012 ~~Explain me~~ → **Explain to me**

"Explain" cannot take a person as a direct object; the person needs the preposition "to."

- Explain it to me.
- She explained the rules to the new staff.

C013 ~~Can you suggest me~~ → **Can you suggest a solution**

"Suggest" cannot be followed directly by a person; you suggest a thing, or suggest something to someone.

- Can you suggest a good restaurant?
- He suggested a different approach to me.

C014 ~~married with~~ → **married to**

The fixed collocation is "married to" someone, not "married with."

- She is married to a doctor.
- He got married to his college sweetheart.

C015 ~~You're coming, isn't it?~~ → **You're coming, aren't you?**

Using "isn't it?" as an all-purpose tag is an Indian-English habit (like Malayalam "alle?"). In standard English the tag repeats the sentence's own helper verb and subject: you're → aren't you, she can → can't she. When unsure, just add "right?"

- You're coming tomorrow, aren't you?
- She can drive, can't she?

C016 ~~enter into the room~~ → **enter the room**

"Enter" is transitive when it means walk into a place, so it needs no preposition. ("Enter into" is only for agreements or negotiations.)

- He entered the room quietly.
- Please enter the building through the side door.

C017 ~~return back~~ → **return**

"Return" already means to come or go back, so "back" is redundant.

- I will return on Monday.
- Please return the book by Friday.

C018 ~~repeat again~~ → **repeat**

"Repeat" already means to do or say something again, so "again" is redundant.

- Could you repeat that, please?
- She repeated the instructions slowly.

C019 ~~revert back~~ → **reply / get back**

"Revert" means to return to a previous state, not to reply. To answer someone, say "reply" or "get back to you."

- I will reply by this evening.
- Let me get back to you tomorrow.

C020 ~~today morning~~ → **this morning**

English uses "this morning / this afternoon / this evening," not "today morning."

- I called you this morning.
- We have a meeting this afternoon.

C021 ~~yesterday night~~ → **last night**

The fixed phrase is "last night," not "yesterday night."

- I slept badly last night.
- Last night we watched a movie.

C022 ~~I have a doubt~~ → **I have a question**

A "doubt" means uncertainty or disbelief; when you want something clarified, the natural word is "question."

- I have a question about the schedule.
- Can I ask a quick question?

C023 ~~cope up with~~ → **cope with**

The verb is "cope with"; there is no "up" in the phrase.

- She copes well with pressure.
- How do you cope with the workload?

C024 ~~order for food~~ → **order food**

"Order" is transitive and takes a direct object with no preposition.

- Let's order food.
- I ordered a coffee.

C025 ~~request for help~~ → **request help / ask for help**

"Request" as a verb takes a direct object with no preposition; if you use "for," switch to "ask for."

- We requested more time.
- She asked for help with the report.

C026 ~~good in English~~ → **good at English**

Skills and abilities take "good at," not "good in."

- She is good at English.
- He is good at solving problems.

C027 ~~interested on~~ → **interested in**

The fixed collocation is "interested in" something.

- I am interested in history.
- Are you interested in joining us?

C028 ~~depend of~~ → **depend on**

The verb takes the preposition "on": you depend on someone or something.

- It depends on the weather.
- We depend on each other.

C029 ~~discussed on~~ → **discussed**

"Discuss" is transitive and takes a direct object directly, with no "on" or "about."

- We discussed the proposal.
- They discussed the results in detail.

C030 ~~listen music~~ → **listen to music**
"Listen" is intransitive and needs the preposition "to" before its object.
- I listen to music while working.
- Listen to me carefully.

C031 ~~search it in Google~~ → **search for it on Google**
You "search for" a thing, and platforms like Google take "on."
- I searched for it on Google.
- Let me search for the address online.

C032 ~~on next week~~ → **next week**
Time phrases with "next," "last," "this," and "every" take no preposition.
- I will see you next week.
- We are traveling next month.

C033 ~~in Monday~~ → **on Monday**
Days of the week and dates take the preposition "on."
- The meeting is on Monday.
- She was born on June 5th.

C034 ~~at morning~~ → **in the morning**
Parts of the day take "in the" (morning/afternoon/evening); "at" is reserved for "at night."
- I exercise in the morning.
- We will meet in the afternoon.

C035 ~~in night~~ → **at night**
"Night" is the exception among parts of the day and takes "at."
- I read at night.
- It gets cold here at night.

C036 ~~I reached to home~~ → **I reached home**
"Reach" is transitive and takes its destination directly; "home" also needs no preposition after motion verbs.
- I reached home by eight.
- We reached the airport early.

C037 ~~I came to know~~ → **I found out / I learned**
"Came to know" is an Indian-English calque; native speakers say "found out" or "learned" for gaining information.
- I found out about it yesterday.
- I learned that the office was closed.

C038 ~~do one thing~~ → **here's what we can do**
"Do one thing" as an opener is an Indian-English calque; native speakers introduce a suggestion with phrases like "here's what we can do."
- Here's what we can do: send the file first.
- How about this — let's call them directly.

C039 ~~kindly do the needful~~ → **Could you please handle this**
"Do the needful" is dated, vague office jargon; a clear request states what you actually want done.
- Could you please handle this?
- Please take care of the rest.

C040 ~~prepone~~ → **move earlier**
"Prepone" is an Indian coinage not used in standard English; say "move earlier" or "bring forward."
- Can we move the meeting earlier?
- They brought the deadline forward by a week.

C041 ~~I am not getting you~~ → **I don't understand what you mean**

"Not getting you" is an Indian-English calque; the natural phrasing is "I don't understand."

- I don't understand what you mean.
- Sorry, I didn't quite follow that.

C042 ~~What is your good name~~ → **What is your name**

"Good name" is a direct translation of a politeness formula; standard English just asks "What is your name?"

- What is your name?
- May I have your name, please?

C043 ~~passed out from college~~ → **graduated from college**

"Pass out" in standard English means to faint; for finishing studies, say "graduated."

- I graduated from college in 2018.
- She graduated with a degree in physics.

C044 ~~out of station~~ → **out of town**

"Out of station" is an Indian-English calque; native speakers say "out of town" when away from home.

- I'll be out of town next week.
- He's out of town on business.

C045 ~~I am staying in Kochi~~ → **I live in Kochi**

For your permanent home, use "live"; "stay" implies a temporary visit, like at a hotel.

- I live in Kochi.
- They live in an apartment near the station.

C046 ~~I stay with my parents~~ → **I live with my parents**

Permanent residence takes "live with"; "stay with" suggests a short visit.

- I live with my parents.
- She lives with two roommates.

C047 ~~I am going to home~~ → **I am going home**

"Home" works as an adverb after motion verbs, so it takes no "to."

- I am going home now.
- He went home early.

C048 ~~more better~~ → **better**

"Better" is already the comparative of "good," so adding "more" doubles the comparison.

- This option is better.
- I feel much better today.

C049 ~~most easiest~~ → **easiest**

"Easiest" is already the superlative, so adding "most" doubles it.

- This is the easiest way.
- That was the easiest exam of all.

C050 ~~less people~~ → **fewer people**

Use "fewer" for things you can count (people), and "less" for uncountable quantities (water, time).

- Fewer people came than expected.
- There were fewer mistakes this time.

C051 ~~many informations~~ → **a lot of information**

"Information" is uncountable, so it has no plural and doesn't take "many"; use "a lot of" or "much."

- I have a lot of information about this.
- We need more information first.

C052 ~~advices~~ → **advice**
"Advice" is uncountable and has no plural; for one item say "a piece of advice."
- Thank you for the advice.
- Let me give you a piece of advice.

C053 ~~furnitures~~ → **furniture**
"Furniture" is uncountable and has no plural; count it as "pieces of furniture."
- We bought new furniture.
- There isn't much furniture in the room.

C054 ~~equipments~~ → **equipment**
"Equipment" is uncountable and has no plural; count it as "pieces of equipment."
- The lab has modern equipment.
- We need more equipment for the trip.

C055 ~~staffs~~ → **staff members**
"Staff" is a collective noun; for individuals say "staff members" or "members of staff."
- All the staff members were present.
- Two staff members are on leave.

C056 ~~childrens~~ → **children**
"Children" is already the plural of "child," so it never takes another "-s."
- The children are playing outside.
- How many children do they have?

C057 ~~peoples~~ → **people**
"People" is already plural; "peoples" only means distinct ethnic groups or nations.
- Many people attended.
- People here are very friendly.

C058 ~~I have 25 years~~ → **I am 25 years old**
In English you "are" an age, using "be," not "have" (which is a translation from other languages).
- I am 25 years old.
- She is ten years old.

C059 ~~Myself Arun~~ → **I am Arun / My name is Arun**
"Myself Arun" is an Indian-English calque; introduce yourself with "I am" or "My name is."
- I am Arun.
- My name is Arun, and I work in sales.

C060 ~~He is my cousin brother~~ → **He is my cousin**
"Cousin" already covers any cousin regardless of gender; "cousin brother/sister" is an Indian-English addition.
- He is my cousin.
- My cousin lives abroad.

C061 ~~She is my real sister~~ → **She is my sister**
"Sister" already means a biological sibling; "real sister" is redundant in standard English.
- She is my sister.
- My sister is two years older than me.

C062 ~~I and my friend~~ → **My friend and I**
Politeness convention puts the other person first, and "I" is correct because it is the subject.
- My friend and I went shopping.
- My colleague and I finished the report.

C063 ~~Me and him went~~ → **He and I went**

As the subject of the verb, use the subject pronouns "he" and "I," not "me" and "him."

- He and I went together.
- She and I are friends.

C064 ~~between you and I~~ → **between you and me**

After a preposition like "between," use object pronouns, so it must be "me," not "I."

- This is between you and me.
- There's no problem between you and me.

C065 ~~I enjoyed a lot~~ → **I really enjoyed it**

"Enjoy" is transitive and needs an object ("it"); "I really enjoyed it" is the natural form.

- I really enjoyed it.
- We really enjoyed the trip.

C066 ~~I am boring~~ → **I am bored**

The "-ing" form describes the cause ("this is boring"), while "-ed" describes how you feel.

- I am bored.
- The kids are bored at home.

C067 ~~I felt very relax~~ → **I felt very relaxed**

"Relax" is a verb; to describe a feeling you need the "-ed" adjective "relaxed."

- I felt very relaxed.
- She looked relaxed after her vacation.

C068 ~~I am confusing~~ → **I am confused**

"-ing" describes what causes the feeling ("the instructions are confusing"); "-ed" describes your own feeling.

- I am confused.
- He was confused by the directions.

C069 ~~It is more easy~~ → **It is easier**

Short adjectives form the comparative with "-er," not "more"; "easy" becomes "easier."

- It is easier than I thought.
- This route is easier to follow.

C070 ~~I did a mistake~~ → **I made a mistake**

Mistakes collocate with "make," not "do"; you make a mistake, an error, a decision.

- I made a mistake.
- Everyone makes mistakes sometimes.

C071 ~~give an exam~~ → **take an exam**

The student "takes" an exam; the teacher "gives" or "sets" it. Reversing them is a common transfer error.

- I take the exam next week.
- She took three exams this term.

C072 ~~write an exam~~ → **take an exam**

Standard usage is "take an exam" for sitting it; "write an exam" is regional.

- I take the final exam tomorrow.
- He took the driving exam twice.

C073 ~~attend the call~~ → **answer the call**

You "answer" a phone call; "attend" is for meetings and events.

- Please answer the call.
- I couldn't answer your call earlier.

C074 ~~cut the call~~ → **hang up**
Ending a phone call is "hang up" (or "end the call"); "cut the call" is an Indian-English calque.
- He hung up before I finished.
- Don't hang up, please.

C075 ~~send me a mail~~ → **send me an email**
"Mail" is uncountable, so "a mail" doesn't work; one electronic message is "an email."
- Send me an email.
- I got your email this morning.

C076 ~~take tension~~ → **worry / feel stressed**
"Take tension" is an Indian-English calque; native speakers say "worry" or "feel stressed."
- Don't worry about it.
- I was really stressed before the interview.

C077 ~~traffic is there~~ → **there is traffic**
English uses the "there is/are" structure to state existence, not "X is there."
- There is heavy traffic today.
- There was a lot of traffic on the bridge.

C078 ~~rain is there~~ → **it is raining**
Weather uses the dummy subject "it" with the verb, not "rain is there."
- It is raining outside.
- It rained all night.

C079 ~~current went~~ → **the power went out**
"Current went" is an Indian-English calque; the standard expression is "the power went out."
- The power went out for an hour.
- The power went out during the storm.

C080 ~~light came~~ → **the power came back**
"Light came" is an Indian-English calque; the standard phrasing is "the power came back (on)."
- The power came back after lunch.
- The power came back on around midnight.

C081 ~~I am having fever~~ → **I have a fever**
"Have" for illness is stative, so it isn't used in the continuous; "fever," "cold," and "headache" also take the article "a."
- I have a fever.
- She has a bad cold.

C082 ~~I got fever~~ → **I got a fever / I came down with a fever**
"Fever" needs the article "a." "I got a fever" is natural, and "came down with" is the usual way to say you got sick.
- I got a fever last night.
- He came down with a fever over the weekend.

C083 ~~loose weight~~ → **lose weight**
"Lose" (verb) means to shed or misplace; "loose" (adjective) means not tight. They are different words.
- I want to lose weight.
- Don't lose your keys.

C084 ~~breath (verb)~~ → **breathe**
"Breath" is the noun; the verb is "breathe," spelled and pronounced with the final "the" sound.
- Breathe slowly and relax.
- Take a deep breath, then breathe out.

C085 ~~Even I like it~~ → **I like it too**

Malayalam "-um" means both "even" and "too," but English splits them: "even I" means "surprisingly, I" (Even I can cook that). To share a feeling or plan, put "too" at the end, or reply "Me too."

- I like it too.
- "I'm tired." "Me too."

C086 ~~Please intimate me~~ → **Please let me know**

"Intimate" as "inform" is dated officialese; the natural phrase is "let me know."

- Please let me know your decision.
- Let me know if anything changes.

C087 ~~I will revert~~ → **I will get back to you**

"Revert" means to return to a previous state, not to reply; say "get back to you."

- I will get back to you by Friday.
- Let me check and get back to you.

C088 ~~club together~~ → **combine**

"Club together" usually means to pool money; for merging items, the clearer verb is "combine."

- Let's combine the two reports.
- We combined both orders into one.

C089 ~~do meeting~~ → **have a meeting**

Meetings collocate with "have" (or "hold"), not "do," and need an article.

- Let's have a meeting tomorrow.
- We had a long meeting today.

C090 ~~make a discussion~~ → **have a discussion**

Discussions collocate with "have" (or "hold"), not "make."

- We had a useful discussion.
- Let's have a discussion about it.

PART II · SPEAKING TOOLKIT / MODULE 11

Conversation Islands

About 80% of everyday and work conversation lands on the same few topics. Instead of inventing answers live, you prepare a small set of 60-second "islands" — short, reusable monologues about your own life. You refine each one over weeks until it comes out smoothly. In real conversations you then *jump between islands* you already own, which removes most freezing.

How To Build An Island

1. Pick one topic below.
2. Speak for 60 seconds. Record it.
3. Keep the 5–8 best sentences. Drop the rest.
4. Re-tell it the next day, a little smoother.
5. An island is "done" when you can tell it with almost no pauses — then keep it warm with occasional retelling.

Use frameworks (*I'm working on...*, *The reason is...*, *These days...*) and chunks (*to be honest*, *at the end of the day*) inside your islands.

The Core 6 Islands

Island 1 — What I do

Your role, your team, what a normal day looks like, what you're responsible for.

- Starters: *I work as... / My main job is to... / On a normal day, I...*

Island 2 — What I'm working on now

Your current project or main task, why it matters, where it stands.

- Starters: *Right now I'm working on... / The goal is to... / We're at the stage where...*

Island 3 — Where I'm from

Your hometown, what it's like, what you like about it, how it compares to where you are now.

- Starters: *I'm originally from... / It's a place where... / The thing I miss most is...*

Island 4 — My weekend / free time

What you usually do, a recent example, what you enjoy about it.

- Starters: *Most weekends I... / Last weekend I... / I'm really into...*

Island 5 — Something I'm learning or improving

A skill, a habit, why you picked it, how it's going.

- Starters: *These days I'm trying to... / The reason I started is... / So far it's...*

Island 6 — A recent problem I handled

A small work or life problem, what you did, how it turned out. (Great for interviews and updates.)

- Starters: *Recently I ran into... / What I did was... / In the end...*

Optional Extra Islands (add later)

- A decision you're weighing right now.
- Your opinion on a change at work.
- A goal for the next few months.

Island Tracker

Island	Last retold	Smoothness / 10	One line to improve
What I do			
What I'm working on			
Where I'm from			
Weekend / free time			
Learning / improving			
Recent problem			

PART II · SPEAKING TOOLKIT / MODULE 12

Prompt Bank

The daily protocol's "prompt activation" step (minutes 7–8) needs something to answer. Pick prompts from here so you never waste time deciding what to talk about. Answer aloud in 2–4 sentences, using at least one framework, chunk, or expression you studied today.

Rotate through them; don't answer the same one two days in a row. Reuse a prompt every couple of weeks to feel the improvement.

Everyday

1. What did you do today?
2. What are your plans for tomorrow?
3. Describe your morning routine.
4. What did you eat today, and was it good?
5. What's the weather like, and how does it affect your day?
6. Tell me about your last weekend.
7. What's something small that made you happy recently?
8. What's something that annoyed you this week?
9. Describe the place where you live.
10. What do you usually do to relax?

Opinions & decisions

1. What's a decision you need to make soon?
2. Do you prefer working from home or the office? Why?
3. What's one thing you would change about your daily schedule?
4. What's a recent purchase you think was worth it?
5. Is it better to plan everything or stay flexible? Why?
6. What's an opinion you hold that others disagree with?
7. What would you do with one extra free hour each day?

Work & professional

1. What did you work on this week?
2. What problem did you solve recently, and how?
3. Explain your current project to someone outside your team.
4. What's blocking you right now?
5. Describe a task you're responsible for.
6. What's the next step on something you're working on?
7. How would you give a status update for this week?
8. Describe a time you disagreed with a colleague politely.
9. What's a priority for you this month?
10. Explain a process you do regularly, step by step.

Stories & experience

1. Tell me about a trip you took.
2. Describe a mistake you made and what you learned.
3. Talk about a person who influenced you.
4. Describe something new you tried recently.
5. Tell me about a time something didn't go as planned.
6. What's a skill you're proud of, and how did you learn it?

Hypothetical & spontaneous (harder)

1. If you could improve one thing about your city, what would it be?
2. Explain how to make your favorite dish.
3. If a friend visited for a day, what would you show them?
4. Describe your ideal weekend.
5. What advice would you give your younger self?
6. Convince me to try a hobby you enjoy.
7. What do you think you'll be working on a year from now?

PART III · ACCENT: GENERAL AMERICAN / MODULE 13

Accent Overview

Goal: sound *minimally-marked* in General American — the point where listeners stop noticing your accent. "Completely undetectable" is the north star; "they stop placing you" is the realistic, achievable deliverable.

Why this is doable without long study or boring audio: an accent is judged from a *small* set of features, not every sound. Hit those and most of the perceived gap closes. And the biggest lever — rhythm — needs almost no audio at all.

The Pareto order (do it in this sequence)

1. **Prosody** (p. 49) — rhythm, stress, weak forms, intonation. **Biggest impact, mostly no audio.** Start here.
2. **The segmental tells** (p. 51) — the ~10 individual sounds that most flag a Malayalam/Indian accent (retroflex t/d, aspiration, v/w, th, rhotic r, diphthongs…).
3. **Connected speech** (p. 53) — blending words so you sound smooth, not word-by-word (flap-T, gonna/wanna, linking).

Drill all three on the **core word list** (p. 55): the most frequent words that carry each tell, so practice lands on the words you say most.

Plus: the **fluency layer** (chunks, islands, bridges) is the *other half* of sounding native — a slight accent with native rhythm and phrasing reads as far more native than perfect sounds delivered haltingly.

How audio works (no files, no long clips)

You never sit through a podcast. When a card says "hear a model," you pull a **single word or line** on demand:

- **YouGlish** (set accent: US) — real native clips of any word/phrase in context.
- **Forvo** — single-word native pronunciations.
- **US text-to-speech** — type your *own* sentence, hear it instantly.

Then **record yourself and compare.** That record-compare loop is the feedback engine.

ADHD ground rules

- Every card is a **20–40 second micro-game**. You never need sustained focus.
- **Pick by mood** from the 5-mode menu (see Micro-Imitation Protocol, p. 57) — novelty is the fuel.
- Shadow **content you already enjoy** or **your own sentences via TTS** — never assigned audio.
- One tiny action, score it, done. Streak beats intensity.

Honest limits

At a few minutes a day you'll get clearly less-marked and smoother. To approach *undetectable* you'll eventually want more daily imitation volume and, ideally, a periodic outside check (a pronunciation app that scores you, or a coach) — because your own ear is the last bottleneck. That's a later phase, not a blocker now.

PART III · ACCENT: GENERAL AMERICAN / MODULE 14

Prosody

Rhythm is the single biggest thing that marks an accent — bigger than any consonant. Malayalam/Indian English gives every syllable near-equal weight; General American is **stress-timed**: strong beats on the important words, and the small words squeezed into a quick "uh" (schwa). Fix this and you sound dramatically less marked, with zero audio needed. Each card is a 20–40 second micro-game.

Notation: **CAPS** = stressed/strong syllable. *uh* = reduced to schwa. • = a beat.

PR01 The de-DUM heartbeat

The tell You give every syllable equal length, so speech sounds even and "machine-gun" — the metronome that screams non-native.

GenAm move Pick a few strong beats per phrase and let everything between them shrink; the gap between beats stays roughly even, not the syllables.

Notation • i'd **LIKE** *tuh* **GO** *tuh thuh* **STORE** • (3 strong beats, the rest squeezed)

Micro-game (20s) Tap the table only on LIKE, GO, STORE and say it 3×, keeping your taps evenly spaced no matter how many tiny words fall between them.

PR02 Content strong, function weak

The tell You stress small grammar words (the, of, to, is, and, can) as loudly as the real words.

GenAm move Punch only the **content** words — nouns, main verbs, adjectives, adverbs; let **function** words (articles, prepositions, pronouns, helpers) go soft and fast.

Notation *thuh* **CAT** *is on thuh* **TA**-*bul in thuh* **KIT**-*chun*

Micro-game (20s) Whisper every weak word and shout every CAPS syllable in the line above, twice — exaggerate the size difference.

PR03 Schwa: reduce to "uh"

The tell You say full clear vowels in the, a, of, to, for ("aae", "tooo", "for") instead of a lazy *uh*.

GenAm move In unstressed spots these collapse: the→*thuh*, a→*uh*, of→*uhv*, to→*tuh*, for→*fer*. The vowel goes to a neutral mumble.

Notation *uh* **CUP** *uhv* **TEA** *fer* **TWO** *uhv us*

Micro-game (20s) Say "a cup of tea for two of us" slowly, then again replacing every small word's vowel with a relaxed *uh* — feel your jaw barely move on them.

PR04 Crushing "to" and "and"

The tell You keep "to" and "and" as crisp separate words, breaking the flow.

GenAm move They glue onto neighbors: want to→*wanna*, going to→*gonna*, fish and chips→*fish'n chips*, rock and roll→*rock'n roll*. (Spoken rhythm, not spelling.)

Notation *i* **WAN**-*nuh* **GO** • **FISH** *'n* **CHIPS** • **ROCK** *'n* **ROLL**

Micro-game (20s) Say "I want to go" three times, getting faster each time until "want to" becomes one smooshed *wanna* beat.

PR05 Word stress: where the beat lands

The tell You put even stress across a word, or stress the wrong syllable, so the word's shape sounds off.

GenAm move Each word has ONE main beat — and it can move: nouns vs verbs often flip. Learn the shape, not just the sounds.

Notation **PHO**-*tuh*-graph • *phuh*-**TOG**-*ruh*-phy • a **RE**-*cord* (noun) vs *tuh* re-**CORD** (verb)

Micro-game (20s) Say "PHOto / phoTOGraphy" back-to-back 3×, sliding the beat forward; then "REcord (the noun) / reCORD (the verb)" 3×.

PR06 Stress in longer words

The tell On big words you spread the energy out, landing flat or on the wrong syllable.

GenAm move Find the one loud syllable and let the rest reduce to schwa around it.

Notation *duh*-**VEL**-*uhp*-*muhnt* • im-**POR**-*tuhnt* • **NES**-*uh*-sair-ee (American English keeps the full "sair")

Micro-game (20s) Hum just the rhythm of each word (da-DA-da-da) first, then drop the syllables in: development, important, necessary — 2× each.

PR07 Sentence stress: the last big word wins

The tell You end sentences flat, or stress an early word, so nothing signals "this is the point."

GenAm move The **tonic** (biggest beat) normally lands on the **last content word** of the group. That word gets length, pitch, and volume.

Notation *i left my* **KEYS** *in the* **CAR**

Micro-game (20s) Say the line and physically lean forward on CAR — make it the longest, highest word. Repeat 3×.

PR08 Contrastive stress

The tell You stress the default word even when you mean to correct or contrast something.

GenAm move Move the big beat onto the word that carries the contrast — it overrides the normal "last word" rule.

Notation *i said the* **RED** *one*, *not the* **BLUE** *one*

Micro-game (20s) Say it three ways, moving the punch each time: "**I** said..." / "I **said**..." / "the **RED** one" — feel the meaning shift.

PR09 Thought groups (chunk + pause)

The tell You pause in random spots (or never), often after small words, so phrasing sounds choppy.

GenAm move Break speech into meaning chunks; pause only at the slashes, ride smoothly through each chunk.

Notation *when i* **GET HOME** / *i'll* **CALL** *you* / *and we'll* **TALK**

Micro-game (20s) Draw a slash where each chunk ends, then say it taking a tiny breath only at each slash — 2×.

PR10 Statements & wh-questions fall

The tell You let the pitch stay flat or rise at the end of statements, which sounds uncertain or "listy."

GenAm move Statements and **wh-questions** (what/where/when/why/how) glide **down** on the tonic word — a confident drop.

Notation *where did you* **PARK** ↘ • *i put it on the* **DESK** ↘

Micro-game (20s) Say each line and drop your hand down through the air on the last word, like landing a plane. 3×.

PR11 Yes/no questions rise

The tell You use the same falling tune for yes/no questions, so they don't sound like questions.

GenAm move Questions answerable by "yes/no" glide **up** at the end — pitch lifts on the tonic.

Notation *are you* **COM**-ing ↗ • *did you eat* **YET** ↗

Micro-game (20s) Say each line and raise your hand upward on the last word; do it once falling (wrong) then rising (right) to feel the difference.

PR12 List & continuation rise-then-fall

The tell You drop your pitch on every list item, making each sound like a finished sentence.

GenAm move **Rise** on each item to signal "more coming," then **fall** on the final one to signal "done."

Notation *eggs* ↗ , *milk* ↗ , *bread* ↗ , *and* **CHEESE** ↘

Micro-game (20s) Count "one ↗, two ↗, three ↗, four ↘" with rising hand on each, dropping only on the last — then swap in eggs/milk/bread/cheese.

Optional model: type the sentence into a US text-to-speech and mimic once.

PART III · ACCENT: GENERAL AMERICAN / MODULE 15

Segmental Tells

You don't need to fix every sound — listeners place an accent from a handful of features. These are the highest-impact ones for a Malayalam/Indian speaker moving toward General American. Each card is a 20–40 second micro-drill: read the fix, do the minimal pair, optionally pull a model and mimic once.

How to hear a model (no files needed): search the word on **YouGlish** (set accent to US) for real native clips, **Forvo** for single words, or type it into any **US text-to-speech**. Then record yourself and compare.

> **Model for every entry:** Search "..." on YouGlish (US) or a US text-to-speech, mimic once, then record & compare.

SG01 Retroflex T/D → alveolar T/D

The tell You curl your tongue tip back to the roof for T and D, giving the hard "Indian" ʈ/ɖ — the biggest single-sound flag.

GenAm move Put your tongue tip flat on the little bump just behind your upper front teeth (the alveolar ridge). No curling back. Tap and release — light, forward, front of the mouth.

Say it /t/ /d/ at the ridge → "time, today, ten, desk"

Minimal pair (20s) Say "today" your usual way, then with the tip flat and forward — alternate 3× and feel the tongue move forward each time.

Model "today"

SG02 Aspiration of P/T/K

The tell Your P/T/K at the start of stressed syllables come out "clean," with no breath — so "pin" sounds clipped, almost like "bin."

GenAm move Release a small puff of air right after the consonant. Hold a tissue an inch from your lips: on "pin / top / key" the tissue should flutter. P/T/K start stressed words with breath.

Say it p^h t^h k^h → "pin, top, key, paper"

Minimal pair (20s) "spin" (no puff) vs "pin" (puff) — say each 3× with the tissue and watch it move only on "pin."

Model "paper"

SG03 V vs W

The tell You merge V and W into one in-between sound (ʊ), so "vet" and "wet" come out the same.

GenAm move For **V**: rest your top teeth lightly on your bottom lip and turn the voice on (buzzing). For **W**: no teeth at all — round your lips like a tiny kiss and glide. Teeth = V, lips = W.

Say it /v/ (teeth+buzz) and /w/ (round lips) → "vet, vine, very" vs "wet, wine, wary"

Minimal pair (20s) "vet / wet" — say each 3×, feel top teeth touch lip on the V and disappear on the W.

Model "very"

SG04 TH /θ/ (think)

The tell You swap the breathy TH for a hard "t" (or sometimes "s"), so "think" becomes "tink."

GenAm move Push your tongue tip lightly between your top and bottom front teeth and blow air through — no voice, just a soft hiss of breath. Pull the tongue back to finish the word.

Say it /θ/ (tongue between teeth, air) → "think, three, both, month"

Minimal pair (20s) "tink / think" — say each 3×, stick the tongue tip out for "think" and feel air over it.

Model "think"

SG05 TH /ð/ (this)

The tell You replace the voiced TH with a hard "d," so "this" becomes "dis."

GenAm move Same tongue position as SG04 — tip lightly between the teeth — but now turn your voice on so it buzzes. It should feel like a soft vibrating hum, not a sharp "d."

Say it /ð/ (tongue between teeth, voiced) → "this, that, mother, they"

Minimal pair (20s) "dis / this" — say each 3×, let the tongue peek out and buzz on "this."

Model "mother"

SG06 GenAm rhotic R

The tell You roll or tap the R, and you drop the R after vowels (so "car" and "work" lose their R).

GenAm move Never tap or roll. Bunch the tongue up and back (or curl the tip slightly) so the whole sound gets an "r-colored" growl — tongue tip touches nothing. Crucially, **keep the R after a vowel**: "car" ends with the R still sounding.

Say it /r/ and /ɚ/ (no tap, hold the R) → "right, car, work, four"

Minimal pair (20s) "caa" (dropped) vs "car" (held R) — say each 3×, growl the R to the very end of "car."

Model "work"

SG07 Diphthongs, not monophthongs

The tell You flatten gliding vowels into a single steady tone — "day" sounds like "deh," "go" like "goh."

GenAm move Let the vowel move. FACE /eɪ/: start "eh" and slide up to "ee." GOAT /oʊ/: start "oh" and round the lips toward "oo." PRICE /aɪ/: start open "ah" and slide to "ee." Two positions in one vowel.

Say it /eɪ/ "say, day" · /oʊ/ "go, no" · /aɪ/ "my, time"

Minimal pair (20s) "deh / day" — say each 3×, let your jaw and lips visibly move on the gliding "day."

Model "day"

SG08 The TRAP vowel /æ/

The tell You raise /æ/ toward /e/, so "bad" drifts near "bed" and "man" near "men."

GenAm move Drop your jaw open wider and spread the lips slightly, tongue low and forward — it's a brighter, flatter "aaa." Open more than feels natural; keep it clearly below "bed."

Say it /æ/ (jaw open, flat) → "cat, bad, man"

Minimal pair (20s) "bed / bad" — say each 3×, drop the jaw lower on "bad" and feel it open.

Model "bad"

SG09 Dark L vs clear L

The tell You use one bright, forward "clear" L everywhere, so "ball" and "cool" sound thin and front-of-mouth.

GenAm move Two L's. **Clear L** before a vowel ("light"): tip up front, sound bright. **Dark L** at the end of a word ("full, ball, cool"): keep the tip up but pull the **back** of the tongue up and back so the L sounds deep and swallowed — almost an "ull/ool."

Say it clear /l/ "light" vs dark /ɬ/ "full, ball, cool"

Minimal pair (20s) "light / ball" — say each 3×, feel L bright and forward on "light," deep and back on "ball."

Model "ball"

SG10 Word-final consonants & clusters

The tell At the end of a word you either add a vowel ("asked-uh") or drop the last sound ("ask," "nex"), so consonant clusters collapse.

GenAm move Land every final consonant cleanly, stacked with no extra vowel between or after them. Say the cluster slowly first, then at speed: "ask-t," "neks-t," "help-t" — all the sounds, nothing added.

Say it keep the final cluster → "asked /æskt/, next /nɛkst/, helped /hɛlpt/"

Minimal pair (20s) "ask / asked" — say each 3×, snap the "-kt" on cleanly with no "uh" after it.

Model "asked"

PART III · ACCENT: GENERAL AMERICAN / MODULE 16

Connected Speech

Native speech is not separate words — it's blended. Even with good sounds, speaking word-by-word marks you as a learner. These are the General American blending rules. Each card is a 20–40 second micro-drill: say the "slow/written" form once, then the "real/blended" form 3×.

How to hear a model (no files needed): search the phrase on **YouGlish** (US) or a **US text-to-speech**, then record & compare.

> Register note: these are for **casual, natural** speech — still fully intelligible, not slang. You'd use them in everyday conversation, interviews, and meetings. You'd only avoid them in very formal speeches or when stressing a word for emphasis.

Micro-drill (20s) for every entry: Say the written form once, then the blended form 3× until it feels lazy and smooth.

CS01 Contractions are the default

Americans almost always shrink "subject + verb" into one word; full forms sound stiff and over-careful.

Written → Real I am ready → I'm ready

More do not know → don't know · it is fine → it's fine · I would go → I'd go · you are late → you're late

CS02 Gonna / wanna / gotta / hafta

Common verb-to-verb pairs collapse: going to → gonna, want to → wanna, got to → gotta, have to → hafta.

Written → Real I am going to call → I'm gonna call

More I want to go → I wanna go · I've got to leave → I gotta leave · I have to work → I hafta work

CS03 Flap T (the signature GenAm sound)

A T or D between two vowels turns into a quick D-like tap of the tongue — light and fast, not a full "t." It only happens when the next vowel is unstressed (after R too: party, forty); before a stressed vowel the T stays crisp — hotel, attack, photography.

Written → Real water → wadder

More better → bedder · got it → goddit · a lot of → a lodda

CS04 Linking consonant → vowel

When a word ends in a consonant and the next starts with a vowel, carry the consonant onto the next word.

Written → Real an apple → a-napple

More pick it up → pi-ki-dup · turn it on → tur-ni-don

CS05 Linking vowel → vowel (tiny glide)

When one word ends in a vowel and the next begins with one, slide between them with a tiny /w/ or /y/ glide — no hard stop.

Written → Real go on → go-won

More I am → I-yam · do it → do-wit · she always → she-yalways

CS06 "You" becomes "ya" / "juh"

Unstressed "you" weakens to "ya," and a preceding d/t often fuses with it into a "j" or "ch" sound.

Written → Real did you → didja

More what do you → whaddaya · don't you → doncha · got you → gotcha

CS07 **Reduced function words (schwa)**

Small grammar words (of, for, and, to, can, your) lose their full vowel and shrink to a quick "uh"-type sound.

Written → Real a cup of tea → a cuppa tea

More for a while → fer a while · bread and butter → bread-n butter · I want to → I wanna · I can go → I kn go · your turn → yer turn

CS08 **Weak pronouns (h-dropping and 'em)**

In unstressed him/her after a verb, the H disappears and the pronoun links onto the word before it; "them" shrinks to 'em the same way.

Written → Real tell him → tell'im

More ask her → ask'er · give them → give'em

CS09 **Held / dropped final T**

A final or medial T often isn't released — it's held silently or swallowed, especially after N or before another consonant.

Written → Real important → impor-nt (T not released)

More can't go → "can'(t) go" (T held silent, no puff) · first thing → firs thing

CS10 **Assimilation (neighbors blend)**

Sounds reshape to match their neighbors — t+y fuses to "ch/j," and n borrows the place of the next sound.

Written → Real would you → wouldja

More don't you → doncha · in the → in-nuh · ten minutes → tem-minutes

PART III · ACCENT: GENERAL AMERICAN / MODULE 17

Core Word List

Your accent is judged on the words you say most, so this is the minimum set to drill: for each accent tell, the most frequent everyday and work words that carry it, most common first. Fix a sound in these words and it disappears from most of your speech. "The," for example, is the most common word in English, so the TH row alone changes almost every sentence you say.

How to use it (60 seconds)

1. Pick one row: today's segmental card's row, or any row by mood.
2. Say the words slowly once, feeling the mouth position from the card, then once at normal speed.
3. Say the chunk 3×, linking the words.
4. Optional: play one word on YouGlish (US) or a US text-to-speech and compare.

One row a day is enough. Repeat rows freely; these are the words that matter.

The sound tells

Tell	Words (most common first)	Say it in a chunk	Card
TH /ð/ (voiced)	the, that, this, they, there, with, them, then	"that's the thing"	SG05
TH /θ/ (breath)	think, thing, thanks, something, nothing, through, both, month	"thanks, I think so"	SG04
V (teeth on lip)	have, very, of, every, even, give, over, value	"very good value"	SG03
W (round lips)	we, was, what, would, will, work, want, one	"what would you want?"	SG03
T/D at the ridge	time, today, take, tell, team, do, day, don't	"talk to the team today"	SG01
Flap T	better, little, pretty, getting, meeting, city, matter, a lot of	"it's getting a little better"	CS03
P/T/K with a puff	people, problem, project, put, come, call, keep, company	"keep people posted"	SG02
R kept after vowels	work, first, more, year, our, here, really, morning	"first thing in the morning"	SG06
Gliding vowels	day, say, make, same, great, go, know, so, okay, only	"okay, same day"	SG07
TRAP /æ/	have, that, back, after, ask, last, actually, happy	"actually, I asked last time"	SG08
Dark L	I'll, will, all, well, call, still, feel, people	"I'll call all of them"	SG09
Clean final consonants	it, but, not, and, just, first, next, asked	"I just asked first"	SG10

"Ask," "after," and "last" take the flat TRAP vowel in American English, not a long "ah": one of the quickest ways to sound American.

Word stress

Long words you use at work. The beat lands on the CAPS syllable; the rest stay small (Prosody PR05–PR06).

Word	Say it
important	im-POR-tunt
decision	dih-SIZH-un
development	dih-VEL-up-munt
available	uh-VAY-luh-bul
information	in-fer-MAY-shun
comfortable	KUMF-ter-bul
interesting	IN-tres-ting
professional	pruh-FESH-uh-nul
category	KAT-uh-gor-ee
colleague	KAH-leeg

Say these the American way

Common words where American English differs from British English.

Word	American
schedule	SKEJ-ool
process	PRAH-sess
project (noun)	PRAH-jekt
progress (noun)	PRAH-gress
data	DAY-duh
either	EE-ther
often	OFF-en (the t is usually silent)
Z (the letter)	zee

Often mispronounced

Word	Say it
said	SED (rhymes with "bed")
says	SEZ
women	WIM-in
Wednesday	WENZ-day
receipt	rih-SEET (silent p)
vehicle	VEE-ih-kul (silent h)
determine	dih-TUR-min
suite	SWEET

PART III · ACCENT: GENERAL AMERICAN / MODULE 18

Micro-Imitation Protocol

Traditional shadowing — sitting through a TED talk and repeating it — does not survive an ADHD brain or boredom. This replaces it with short hits (20 seconds to 2 minutes) riding on content you already like or sentences you actually use. No long audio, ever.

The 5-Mode Menu — pick ONE by mood each day

You don't follow a fixed routine. Each day, glance at the menu and pick whatever you can stand right now. Novelty is the point.

Mode	What you do	Time	Needs
1. Stress-tap	Take any sentence, tap the strong beats while you say it (prosody cards)	20s	nothing
2. Minimal pair	One segmental card — say the contrast pair, then its row in the core word list	30s	nothing
3. Echo-a-show	Pause something you're watching, repeat the last line in their voice	30s	a show you like
4. TTS-your-line	Type a sentence YOU want to say into US text-to-speech, mimic it 3×	1 min	phone/ browser
5. Record-compare	Record one sentence, play a model (YouGlish/TTS), fix one thing, re-record	2 min	phone

Most days = Mode 1, 2, or 3. Modes 4–5 on review days or when you have energy.

Mode 3 — Echo-a-show (the best ADHD fit)

While watching anything with General American speakers (a show, a YouTuber, a movie) — **the entertainment carries your attention, you smuggle in a rep:**

1. When a line lands, pause.
2. Say it once, copying the rhythm and tone, not just the words.
3. Unpause. That's it.

- One good line a day beats a forced 20-minute session.
- Mimic the *melody* (up/down, which word is loudest), not only the sounds.

Mode 4 — TTS-your-own-line (zero hunting)

The lowest-friction option, and it doubles as fluency practice because you use *your* content:

1. Type a sentence from your conversation islands or something you'll actually say.
2. Play it in a US text-to-speech voice.
3. Say it with the voice 3×, then once on your own.

- This fuses accent + fluency on material you care about — no searching for "interesting" audio.

Mode 5 — Record-compare (the feedback engine)

Once or twice a week:

1. Record yourself saying one sentence.
2. Play a model: the same words on YouGlish (US) or TTS.
3. Find **one** difference (a beat in the wrong place, a flat vowel, a missing flap-T).
4. Fix that one thing and re-record. Done.

- One fix per session. Don't chase everything.

Scoring & streak

End each micro-session with a 0–3 tap:

- 0 = skipped, 1 = did it, 2 = felt one improvement, 3 = nailed it. Track the streak, not perfection. The win condition is *showing up daily*, because accent change is cumulative reps, not big sessions.

How it plugs into the daily loop

Minute 9 of Daily 10-Minute Protocol (p. 5) is your accent slot — just run one menu mode. That's enough to compound over weeks. Add a second mode anytime you've got the spark; never force it.

PART IV · TRACKERS / MODULE 19

Progress Tracker

Copy this table for each week.

Day	Minutes	Cards Practiced	Retrieval / 10	Hesitation / 10	Confidence / 10	Longest run (s)	Note
Mon	10						
Tue	10						
Wed	10						
Thu	10						
Fri	10						
Sat	10	mixed					
Sun	10	recording					

(Longest run = seconds of speech without a pause longer than 2 seconds. Track it mainly on the recording day.)

Weekly Summary

Best framework:

Best chunk:

Best expression:

Most repeated mistake:

Accent focus (prosody/sound):

Island retold:

One visible improvement:

Next week focus: